

February

12

1947

Dior's New Look

French fashion designer Christian Dior presented his "New Look" collection in Paris. Models wore elegant jackets and stylish, form-fitting dresses, which became a fashion sensation all around the world.



Born this day

1809 Charles Darwin, British naturalist. His theory of natural selection changed the course of science and our view of history.

1881 Anna Pavlova, Russian ballet dancer. She was the first ballerina to tour the world, and is famous for her solo role in *The Dying Swan*.

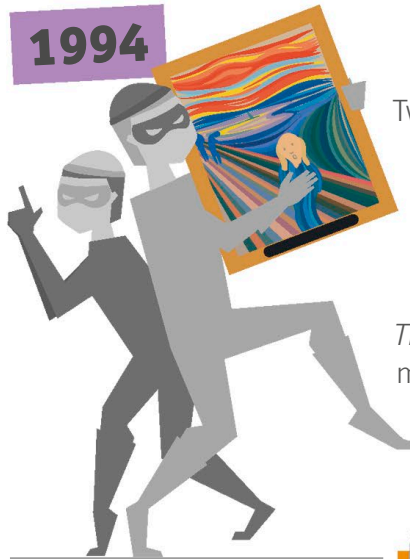
Also on this day

1818 Chile officially declared its independence from Spain, after nearly 300 years of colonial rule.

1909 The National Association for the Advancement of Colored People (NAACP) was founded to bring an end to racial discrimination in the USA.

2001 *NEAR Shoemaker* became the first space probe to orbit and land on an asteroid, 433 Eros.

1994



Stealing The Scream

Two thieves broke into the National Gallery in Oslo, Norway. They sneaked out with Norwegian artist Edvard Munch's most famous painting, *The Scream*. Almost three months later, it was safely recovered and returned.

1912

The last emperor

Nearly 2,000 years of imperial rule ended in China when six-year-old Emperor Puyi was forced to abdicate (give up the throne) after three years in power.

